



GUT FEELING

Diagnosis Pocket Companion

Observation · Inquiry

Palpation · Hearing & Smelling

VOLUME 2

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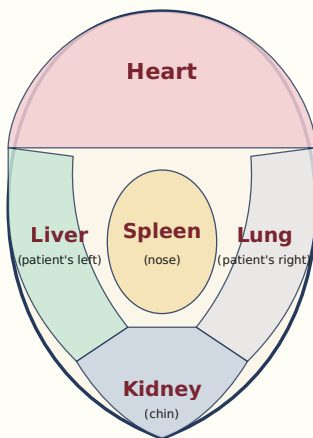
PART FIVE

Observation

望診 Wàng Zhǎn

The first of the remaining Four Pillars — Shen, facial complexion, the eyes, and every visible feature from hair to nails. 27 entries.

The Facial Five-Phase Map



Su Wen 32. Heat disease in the Liver reddens the left cheek first; Heart, the forehead; Spleen, the nose; Lung, the right cheek; Kidney, the chin. This map is drawn facing the patient – "left" and "right" are the PATIENT'S own left and right, not the viewer's. Getting this backwards is the single most common mistake on this material.

Having Shen vs. Loss of Shen

有神 · 失神

Sign	Having Shen	Loss of Shen
Complexion	Bright, moist sheen	Dim, dull sheen
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision
Mind	Clear speech, agile response	Unconscious, delirious
Motion	Free, quick response	Slow, awkward
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult
Diet	Strong appetite	Poor

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Shen is why an apple with a dull skin sits in the discount bin and a shiny one doesn't. Same fruit, same nutrients technically — but the vibrancy is the tell. A person is no different: the eyes and complexion either have that spark or they don't.

False Shen & Deranged Spirit

假神 · 神亂

False Shen: a person in critical condition — listless, dull-eyed, feeble voice — has a sudden jolt: clear consciousness, bright eyes, loud voice, flushed cheeks, improved "appetite. Then it goes out. Classic pre-death phenomenon, not a real recovery.

MANIFESTATIONS OF DERANGED SPIRIT

Irritability/Restlessness (fán záo): hot, heavy, feverish, prefers nudity, may jump "into water.

Visceral Agitation (zàng zào): hallucinations, disorientation, "melancholy/crying spells, yawning, no loss of consciousness.

Lily Disease: chronic "depression, apathy, mumbling to self, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking.

Yin Madness "(diān): depression, aversion to speaking, laughing/crying inappropriately — inward."

Yang Madness (kuáng): raving, obscenities, restlessness, singing at high places, "wandering naked, destroying things — outward.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

False Shen is the candle's last flare before going out — or that green flash right as the sun drops below the horizon. Beautiful, sudden, and the dark follows immediately after.

Facial Diagnosis — The Five-Phase Map

面診 Miàn Zhǎn

Su Wen 32: heat disease in the Liver → left cheek reddens first. Heart → "forehead. Spleen → nose. Lung → right cheek. Kidney → chin.

THE QUIZ TRAP

Left/right on this map means the *patient's* left and right, not the viewer's. Draw the "map facing the patient and Liver/Metal ends up swapped from where your hand naturally wants to "put it. Schrier flags this directly as a quiz and final question.

NORMAL COMPLEXION

Gentle sheen, subtle reddish hue, moisture present, color "contained" (not blotchy or "patchy). Host color = unchanging baseline. Guest color = normal seasonal/climate shift.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same trap as reading an X-ray backwards. The map is correct — it's *your orientation to it* that flips.

White/Pale Complexion

白色

Color	Indication
Pale white / dull white	Qi or Blood Deficiency
Bright white (puffy, bloated)	Yang Deficiency
Pale blue-white	Cold with Yang Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

White is absence — not enough Blood to redden the face, or not enough Yang to push warmth and color to the surface. Puffy-white specifically means fluids aren't being moved, not just that color is missing.

Yellow Complexion

黃色

Color	Indication
Bright orange-yellow	Yang Jaundice — Damp-Heat, heat > damp
Smoky, hazy, dull yellow	Yin Jaundice — Damp-Heat, damp > heat (or "plain Damp-Cold, depending on source)
Sallow yellow	Spleen/Stomach Deficiency or Blood Deficiency — no heat or "damp signs
Dull pale yellow, ash-like	Cold-Damp, long-term dampness
Pale yellow with red spots	Spleen Deficiency with Liver Blood Stasis

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Yellow always points to Earth/Spleen and Dampness somewhere — the differentiator is everything else in the room: heat signs (thirsty, irritable, feels hot) vs. plain deficiency signs (tired, poor digestion, no heat or cold complaints at all) tell you which yellow you're looking at.

Red Complexion

紅色

Pattern	Indication
Red over entire face	Full/Excess Heat
Red cheeks only (malar flush)	Empty/Deficient Heat
Superficial zygomatic flush, pale beneath	Floating Yang — heat floating on "the surface over an underlying deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Full-face red is the whole stove is on. A flush confined to just the cheekbones, especially with paleness underneath, is a candle burning down fast rather than a bonfire — Empty Heat, not Full.

Green & Blue-Green Complexion

青色

Pattern	Indication
Green under eyes / cheeks	Liver Qi Stagnation or Liver Blood Stasis
Green with red tinge	Shaoyang pattern – alternating hot/cold
Green with red eyes	Liver Fire (heat rising to the eyes)
Pale green under eyes	Liver Blood Deficiency
Dark blue under eyes	Cold in the Liver
Bluish-green (children)	Liver Wind

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Green/blue-green is Liver's color no matter what – the question is always which Liver pattern: stuck (stagnation), thick and pooled (stasis), frozen (cold), or moving on its own (wind).

Black/Grayish Complexion

黑色

Pattern	Indication
Dark, moist	Kidney-Yin cold pattern
Dark, dried, burnt	Empty Heat from Kidney-Yin Deficiency
Black without brightness, scaly	Blood Stasis

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Black is Kidney/Water territory, full stop. Wet-dark means cold water pooling with nowhere to go; dry-and-burnt-dark means the water's run out and what's left is scorched.

The Five Wheels of the Eye

五輪 Wǔ Lún

Ling Shu 80: "The essence of the five Zang and six Fu pours upward into the eyes."

Wheel	Location	Organ
Blood Wheel	Inner & outer canthus	Heart
Qi Wheel	Sclera (whites)	Lung
Wind Wheel	Iris	Liver
Water Wheel	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh Wheel	Eyelids	Spleen/Stomach

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Five zones, five organs, one eye — the classic "wink wink nudge nudge" chart. Whites= Lung/Metal makes intuitive sense once you say it out loud (white, after all).

Eye Color

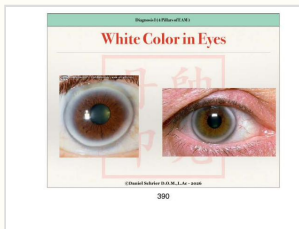
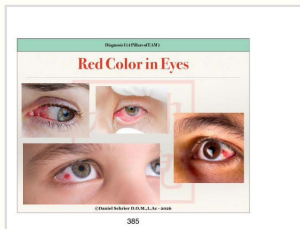
目色

Color	Indication
Red	Pathogenic heat injuring blood vessels, pushing blood up
White (pale sclera)	Blood Deficiency, or Yang Deficiency with Cold
Yellow	Liver/Gallbladder obstructed by Damp, Qi, or Blood Stasis (bile steaming "up")
Black	Extreme Heat consuming fluids & concentrating Blood; also Kidney
Blue-green	Wind or Liver dysfunction

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same five-color logic as the face and tongue, just concentrated into a much smaller canvas — the eye is basically a miniature complexion chart.

Eye Color — Photo Reference



Red (pathogenic heat pushing Blood up) and white/pale (Blood or Yang Deficiency) — the two ends of the eye-color spectrum, side by side.

Schrier

Eye Shape

目形

Shape	Indication
Sunken	Less nourishment/support — deficiency
Swollen	Heat or Damp accumulation
Bulging	Exuberant Zheng Qi struggling against excess pathogens, pushing the "eyeball outward

NOTABLE PATTERNS

Sunken after profuse vomiting/diarrhea = Yin/Yang Deficiency after fluid loss. Bulging with "neck swelling, dizziness, tinnitus, five-center heat = Liver Yin Deficiency with relative Yang "excess.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sunken = not enough behind it to fill the socket. Bulging = too much pressure pushing from behind. Swollen = something's accumulated that shouldn't be there.

Eye Movement

目動

Strabismus (sudden, one eye, no redness): Wind attacking the channels.

Strabismus (difficult to move, nausea, greasy coat, slippery pulse): Damp-Phlegm " "obstructing.

Both eyes deviate, high fever, convulsion: Blood Stagnation creating " "internal Wind.

Eyelid spasms, dry/itchy eyes: Blood Deficiency.

Drooping " "eyelid, slow onset, fatigue: Qi Sinking.

Drooping, acute onset, aversion to cold: " "Wind attacking the channels.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sudden + one-sided + no redness reads Wind almost every time in facial/eye movement patterns — it's the single fastest sorting question to ask.

Nose

鼻

Sign	Indication
Slightly moist, shiny	Good prognosis (normal)
Dry	Heat in Stomach or Large Intestine
Dry and black	Toxic Heat
Green/blue tip	Abdominal pain from Cold in the Spleen
Yellow tip	Damp-Heat in the Spleen
White tip	Blood Deficiency
Red tip	Heat in Lung and Spleen
Greenish bridge	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Grey/dark bridge	Liver-Blood Stasis
Swollen / Sunken	Excess / Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A dog's nose or a cat's nose is the benchmark Schrier uses: a little moist and shiny is healthy. Bone dry or wet-and-crusty are both the tell of something off.

Ears

耳

Color: white = sudden Wind-Cold; green-black = pain; black = Kidney failure; "red = excess heat; yellow = Damp accumulation.

Shape: thin = Qi/Blood Deficiency. Long, full earlobes = strong constitution. Small "earlobes = poor constitution.

Texture: dry, withered earlobes = Kidney exhaustion, poor prognosis. Shiny, moist "earlobes = good prognosis.

Discharge: yellow/white pus = Kidney-Yin Deficiency with Fire, or Damp-Heat in Liver/"Gallbladder.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

The visible diagonal crease some people have across the earlobe (the "earlobe crease") is a real, if informal, marker some practitioners flag as correlating with cardiovascular risk — worth a mental note, not a diagnosis on its own.

Teeth & Gums

齒 · 齦

Teeth map to Kidney (bones). White, moist sheen = strong Kidney Qi. Dry, no sheen " " = Kidney-Yin decline. Dull like a soybean = Kidney failure. Delayed baby/adult teeth = "Essence/Jing Deficiency. Teeth growing at deviated angles = Yangming Qi Deficiency (not " " enough Earth-Qi to hold them in place).

Gums map to Flesh (Spleen/Stomach). Moist = normal. Deep red + swelling = Excess " "Heat. Pale = Blood Deficiency. Atrophied = Kidney Deficiency. Blue line at the gum-tooth "border" = mercury poisoning (rare, but a real clinical sign to know).

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Teeth = the bone/Kidney story. Gums = the flesh/Spleen story. Same neighborhood, two different organs telling two different parts of it.

Lips

唇

Normal: red, lustrous, neither swollen/atrophied nor deviated/shaking, free and flexible " "movement. Maps to Heart/Spleen/Stomach (Blood, red color), Kidney/Lung/Spleen (fluids, " "moisture), Spleen/Liver (muscles, flexibility).

Pattern	Indication
Pale lips	Blood Deficiency or Qi Deficiency
Red, swollen, dry mouth, dry yellow coat	Excess Heat in Spleen/Stomach
Purple, dark	Cold Blood Stasis
Purple, bluish	Cold
Purple, reddish	Heat coagulating the Blood
Chapped, dry, no thirst	Lung/Stomach pattern
Swollen, itching, burning	Spleen/Stomach Heat

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Lips are basically a second, smaller tongue-body reading — same color logic (pale= deficient, red=heat, purple=stasis), just a different piece of real estate.

Mouth



Pattern	Indication
Deviated, one side, no other symptoms	Wind attacking the collaterals
Deviated with hemiplegia, loss of consciousness	Wind Stroke
Open, slightly, tired	Deficiency pattern (not enough Yang to close it)
Remains open, high fever, red face, thirst	Excess Heat
Open, breathing with cough & frothy sputum	Lung Deficiency with Phlegm "
Sudden, open, drooling, loss of consciousness	"Stagnation
	Wind

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Deviated mouth follows the exact same Wind-logic as deviated tongue and strabismus — three different locations, one repeating pattern-recognition rule across this whole section.

Throat & Tonsils

咽喉 · 扁桃

Throat: deep red = Heat (interior or exterior). Pale-red = Empty Heat. Acute pain " " + redness + swelling = Wind-Heat invasion. Chronic pain + redness + swelling = Stomach-Heat. " "Chronic sore, dry, not swollen/red = Lung/Kidney-Yin Deficiency with Empty Heat.

Tonsils: swollen, normal color = Damp/Phlegm retention against Qi Deficiency. " "Chronically red/swollen = Heat or Toxic Heat in Stomach/Large Intestine. Acutely red/swollen = " "Wind-Heat invasion with Toxic Heat. Grey-ish = acute glandular fever (mono).

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Acute vs. chronic is the fastest sort here: sudden and inflamed points to an active invasion (Wind-Heat), while something that's been dry and sore for a while without much redness points to a long-standing Yin-Deficiency Empty Heat instead.

Nails

爪甲

Normal: pink, shiny, appropriately thick, no ridges or breaks.

Finding	Indication
Pale nail bed	Blood Deficiency
Ridges	Blood Deficiency with Wind, or Kidney-Yin Deficiency with Liver-Yang "Rising
Hook-shaped	Qi and Blood Stagnation, or Wind-Painful Obstruction
Spoon-shaped	Qi/Blood Stagnation, or Qi Deficiency with Blood Stagnation
Twisted and bent	Liver-Yin Deficiency, or Liver-Blood Deficiency, chronic Bi "Syndrome

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Nails grow slowly, so a nail-shape change is reading weeks-to-months of history, not today's snapshot — more like the tongue's cracks than the pulse's real-time read.

Infant Finger Vein

小兒指紋

A pediatric diagnostic technique for children too young for reliable pulse-taking. Rub "the vein on the radial side of the index finger, proximal direction. Three segments: Gate/"Bar (metacarpophalangeal), Bar (proximal interphalangeal), and beyond into the "Life Gate."

COLOR SIGNIFICANCE

Bright red = Heat-related disease. Purple = Heat is strong. Green or dark blue = Wind. "Normal: when rubbed, the vein turns light red and is barely visible.

SEVERITY BY EXTENT

The further the visible vein extends through the three segments toward the Life Gate, the "more severe/advanced the condition is considered.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

This is the pediatric equivalent of pulse-taking — a toddler's wrist doesn't give you much to work with, so this vein on the index finger becomes the stand-in read.

Skin — Color & Moisture

皮膚

Skin inspection reflects Lung function specifically, plus overall excess/deficiency, "Qi/Blood state, and the thermal nature of a pathogen.

Finding	Indication
Yellow, bright (jaundice)	Yang Jaundice — Damp-Heat
Yellow, dull (jaundice)	Yin Jaundice — Cold-Damp
White patches, gradually spreading	Vitiligo from Wind-Damp attack
Dry skin	Deficiency of Lung Qi or Body Fluids

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Skin is the Lung's report card — the same organ that governs the exterior/Wei Qi layer shows its state most directly here, on the largest exterior surface the body has.

Skin Lesions

皮疹

Type	Description
Papule (zhǎn)	"Rash," seed-sized, red, distinct borders, raised, disappears " "under pressure
Plaque	Red patches/spots, flat, clear edge, color doesn't fade with pressure
Blister (pào)	Raised, needle-tip to boil-sized, contains clear or turbid "fluid"
Nodule (jié)	Palpable, solid, round lesion

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Four different textures, four different underlying mechanisms — whether it disappears under a fingertip press (papule) or stays put (plaque) is often the fastest way to tell two similar-looking red marks apart.

Edema & Joint Swelling

水腫 · 關節腫

Location	Indication
Edema of the hands	Lung-Yang Deficiency
Edema of the feet	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Edema of the four limbs	Spleen-Yang Deficiency
Acute edema of the hands	Wind-Water invasion

Joint swelling: most often Painful Obstruction (Bi Syndrome), usually from Dampness; "in chronic cases Dampness develops into Phlegm, obstructing joints and causing bone "deformities. Red and hot to the touch = Damp-Heat retention.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Edema location maps to the exact same Yang-organ logic as everywhere else in this book: hands=Lung, feet=Kidney, all-over=Spleen — the same three-organ fluid-metabolism team that shows up throughout the whole course.

Limb Movement Patterns

肢體動作

Pattern	Key Cause
Flaccidity (soft, limp, not atrophied)	Wind-Heat injuring Lungs, or Damp-Heat "in Stomach/Spleen
Rigidity (can't extend joints)	Acute: Wind invasion. Chronic: Liver-Yang "Rising, Liver/Kidney-Yin Deficiency
Paralysis	Damp retention, Blood Stasis, Qi/Blood Deficiency, Liver/Kidney-Yin "Deficiency
Contraction	Full: Damp or Heat obstructing. Empty: Liver-Blood or Liver-Yin "Deficiency
Tremor	Liver-Wind (Full-Wind if coarse, Empty-Wind if fine)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Five different words for "the limb isn't moving right," and each one names a specific failure mode: too loose (flaccid), too locked (rigid), no control at all (paralysis), pulled in (contraction), or shaking (tremor).

Body Signs & Demeanor

體態 · 舉止

Movement: excess of movement = Yang/Full/Heat. Lack of movement = Yin/Empty/Cold. "Quick movements + feeling of heat = Excess. Slow movements + feeling of cold = Deficiency.

Body shape: large barrel chest/epigastrium = Full condition of Lung/Stomach. Large, "overweight thighs = Spleen Deficiency. Thin body = Yin Deficiency. Overweight body = Yang "Deficiency and Phlegm.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

The whole body is read the same way a single pulse quality is: fast and hot points one direction, slow and cold points the other — the eight-principles logic just scales up from the wrist to the entire frame.

Excreta & Secretions — Quick Framework

排泄物

General framework applied across urine, stool, sputum, and discharge:

Variable	Cold Direction	Heat Direction
Color	Clear, white	Yellow, red
Quality	Thin, watery, formless	Thick, sticky
Odor	No odor	Strong odor
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Cold doesn't smell because cold doesn't cook anything — a piece of meat straight from the freezer has no odor, but leave it on the counter (heat) and it stinks within hours. Same principle applies to every excretion in the body.

Constitutional Types

體質

Schrier explicitly states: constitutional typing (Ling Shu 54's Weak/Strong Constitution " "markers, the Five-Sound body types) is **not tested** on quizzes or the final. It's real, " "interesting material — physical markers like ear size, jaw shape, and philtrum length " "correlating with constitutional strength — but it sits outside this course's scope.

One idea worth keeping regardless: constitution is not fixed. Pre-Heaven Essence can be " "replenished within limits by a healthy lifestyle, breathing practices, and physical " "exercise.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Calm, not urgent: this is genuinely good material, just not exam material. Read it for interest, don't lose sleep memorizing ear-lobe lengths.

PART SIX

Inquiry

問診 Wèn Zhǎn

Pain theory, body-region symptom clusters, and the special populations — women's health, pediatrics. 29 entries.

THE 16 QUESTIONS

Pain · Food & Taste · Emotions · Thirst & Drink · Energy Levels · Sexual Life · Sweating · Ears & Eyes · Feeling of Cold/Heat/Fever · Emotional Symptoms · Sleep · Stool · Urination · Menses · Discharge · General History

Pain — Where It Comes From

痛之源

Su Wen 39: pain results from cold Qi entering the vessels, causing stoppage and retardation — circulation impeded. Ling Shu 47: pain from lack of nourishment when Qi and Blood cannot properly moisten the sinews and joints.

NOT TESTED

Su Wen 39's detailed "14 Kinds of Pain" table (specific cold-Qi-guest locations mapped to exact pain qualities) is explicitly flagged by Schrier as not tested. Know the concept exists; don't memorize the table.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Traffic analogy, straight from lecture: no movement, no pain (free-flowing highway). Add tension (a traffic jam) and pain shows up immediately. Circulation impeded = pain, full stop.

Pain — By Cause

痛因

Cause	Pain Quality
Exterior invasion	Sudden, often with aversion to cold/wind
Qi stagnation	Distending, moves around, worse with emotional stress
Blood stasis	Severe, boring or stabbing, fixed location
Cold	Severe, relieved by warmth
Heat	Burning
Dampness	Fixed, heavy sensation, worse in chest/epigastrium
Deficiency (Qi/Blood/Yin)	Dull, relieved by pressure/rest

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Fixed and stabbing = something is physically stuck (stasis).
Moving and distending = energy is stuck but not blood (stagnation). Dull and better with pressure = there's just not enough there to begin with (deficiency).

Joint Pain — Bi Syndrome Types

痺證

Type	Pattern	Pathogen
Wandering	Moves joint to joint	Wind
Painful	Severe, fixed, worse with cold	Cold
Fixed	Soreness, heaviness	Damp
Heat	Sudden onset, swelling, redness	Heat
Bone (chronic)	Pain, swelling, joint deformity	Chronic progression of "the above four"

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Four pathogens, four joint-pain personalities: Wind never stays put (wandering), Cold locks things down (painful/fixed sensation), Damp sits heavy, Heat announces itself with redness and swelling.

Headache — Onset & Timing

頭痛：時間

Pattern	Indication
Recent onset, short duration	Exterior attack of Wind-Cold
Gradual onset, in attacks	Interior type
Daytime	Qi or Yang Deficiency
Evening	Blood or Yin Deficiency
Night-time	Blood Stasis

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same day/night logic that shows up everywhere in this course: daytime problems trace to Yang/Qi, nighttime problems trace to Yin/Blood.

Headache — By Channel Location

頭痛：部位

Location	Channel	Common Cause
Nape of neck	Taiyang	Exterior invasion, or interior Kidney Deficiency
Forehead	Yangming	Stomach-Heat or Stomach Deficiency
Temples/ sides	Shaoyang	Exterior Wind in Lesser Yang, or Liver/" Gallbladder Fire rising
Vertex	Jueyin	Usually Liver-Blood Deficiency
Whole head	—	Exterior Wind-Cold

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

The exact same six-channel map used for pulse and pattern differentiation everywhere else in the course, just applied to "where does it hurt on the head" specifically.

Pain by Body Region

部位痛

Region	Organ	Key Pattern
Chest	Heart/Lung	Stabbing=Heart Blood Stasis; with cough+yellow " "sputum=Phlegm-Heat in Lungs
Hypochondrium	Liver/ Gallbladder	Distention=Qi; stabbing=Blood Stasis
Epigastrium	Stomach	Relieved by eating=Empty; aggravated by " "eating=Full
Abdomen	Spleen/ Intestines	Relieved by bowel movement=Full; aggravated=" "Empty
Hypogastrum	Bladder	Damp-Heat in the Bladder

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Five body regions, five different organ stories — and "does eating/a bowel movement make it better or worse" is the fastest Empty-vs-Full sort for the middle two.

Food & Taste

食味

Finding	Indication
Relieved by eating	Empty condition
Aggravated by eating	Full condition
Lack of appetite	Spleen-Qi Deficiency
Excessive hunger	Stomach-Heat
Feeling of fullness	Dampness or food retention
Feeling of distention	Qi Stagnation
Bitter taste	Heat in Liver or Heart
Sweet taste	Spleen Deficiency or Damp-Heat
Sour taste	Retention of food, or Liver invading Stomach
Salty taste	Kidney pattern
Lack of taste sensation	Spleen/Stomach Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Bitter in the morning after bad sleep points Heart; bitter constant all day points Liver — same taste, different timing, different organ.

Vomiting

嘔吐

Finding	Indication
Sour flavor	Liver invading the Stomach
Bitter flavor	Liver and/or Gallbladder-Heat
Clear, watery	Cold in the Stomach
Soon after eating	Heat in the Stomach
Sudden onset	Wind or Cold invasion

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same logic as diarrhea and every other excretion in this course: clear and watery points cold, sour/bitter/soon-after-eating all point toward heat somewhere in the digestive chain.

Stools & Constipation

便秘

Finding	Indication
Difficulty passing (not dry)	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Constipation with abdominal pain	Internal Cold (Full or Empty)
Dry stools, dry mouth, small sips	Yin Deficiency (Kidney/Stomach)
Alternating constipation/diarrhea	Stagnant Liver-Qi invading Spleen

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Dry vs. just-difficult-to-pass is the key distinguishing question — dry points to Yin Deficiency (not enough fluid), difficult-but-not-dry points to Qi Stagnation (fluid's there, movement isn't).

Stools & Diarrhea

腹瀉

Finding	Indication
Chronic, every day very early morning	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
With mucus and blood	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
With undigested food	Spleen-Qi Deficiency
Frequent, can't hold, not very loose	Central Qi Deficiency (Spleen-Qi "sinking")
Black/very dark	Blood Stasis
Borborygmus with loose stools	Spleen Deficiency
Borborygmus with distention, no loose stools	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Foul-smelling	Heat
No smell	Cold
Burning sensation in anus	Heat

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same freezer-vs-counter meat analogy from Observation applies here too: cold doesn't smell, heat does. If it stinks, look toward heat; if it's nearly odorless, look toward cold.

Urination

小便

Category	Finding	Indication
Function	Enuresis/ incontinence	Kidney Deficiency
Function	Retention	Damp in Bladder, or Lung-Qi Deficiency
Pain	Before urination	Qi Stagnation, Lower Burner
Pain	During urination	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Pain	After urination	Qi Deficiency
Color	Pale/clear	Cold
Color	Dark	Heat
Color	Turbid/cloudy	Dampness
Amount	Very frequent, copious	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Amount	Frequent, scanty	Qi Deficiency
Amount	Scanty, dark	Kidney-Yin Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Even bubbles in the toilet get a read: persistent bubbles (not just the initial splash) can point toward excess protein/Heat and Yang in the body, per Schrier's own clinical framing.

Thirst & Drink

口渴

Finding	Indication
Desire for cold liquids	Heat pattern
Desire for warm liquids	Cold pattern
Thirst, large amounts of cold water	Excess Heat
Absence of thirst	Cold, or no fluid damage yet
Thirsty but no desire to drink	Damp-Heat — heat present, but Dampness "obstructs and creates fullness"

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Schrier's own flagged example: "I'm thirsty, but I don't want to drink" is the patient handing you Damp-Heat in their own words — heat shows up as thirst, but the obstruction of dampness kills the desire to actually drink.

Energy Levels & Tiredness

精力

Finding	Indication
Sleepy after eating	Spleen-Qi Deficiency
Chronic, weak voice, catches colds easily	Lung-Qi/Yang Deficiency
Extreme lethargy, feels cold	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Chronic, dizziness, blurred vision, scanty periods	Liver-Blood Deficiency
Chronic, feeling of heaviness	Dampness
Chronic, heaviness + dizziness	Phlegm
Short-term, alternating hot/cold, irritability	Shaoyang (Lesser Yang) pattern
Lethargic stupor + rattling throat, slippery pulse	Phlegm misting the Mind

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Tiredness alone tells you almost nothing – it's the organ-specific companion signs (catches colds=Lung, dizziness+blurred vision=Liver-Blood, feels cold=Kidney-Yang) that actually sort it.

Sweating — Location, Timing & Quality

汗證

Location/Type	Indication
Head only	Heat in Stomach or Damp-Heat
Oily, forehead	Collapse of Yang
Arms/legs only	Stomach and Spleen Deficiency
Hands only	Lung-Qi or Heart-Qi Deficiency
Palms, soles, chest	Yin Deficiency (five-palm heat)
Daytime	Yang Deficiency
Night-time	Yin Deficiency (occasionally Damp-Heat)
Profuse, cold, during severe illness	Collapse of Yang
Yellow	Damp-Heat

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sweating location is a real diagnostic map, not just "do you sweat a lot" — palms only vs. head only vs. whole body each point somewhere completely different.

Ears — Tinnitus & Deafness

耳鳴 · 耳聾

Finding	Indication
Sudden onset	Full condition — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang Rising, or "Liver-Wind"
Gradual onset	Empty condition — Kidney/Heart-Blood/Upper Burner Qi "Deficiency"
Worse with pressure on ears	Full condition
Better with pressure on ears	Empty condition
High-pitched, like a whistle	Liver-Yang, Liver-Fire, Liver-Wind
Low-pitched, like rushing water	Kidney Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

High-pitched = Liver (think cicadas, a springtime insect sound).
 Low-pitched = Kidney (think deep, rushing water). Same pitch logic that shows up in the Five Wheels/eye material.

Eyes — Pain, Vision & Dryness

目痛 · 目乾

Finding	Indication
Pain, swelling, redness	Wind-Heat invasion or Liver-Fire
Feeling of pressure	Kidney-Yin Deficiency
Blurred vision + floaters	Liver-Blood, Liver-Yin, or Kidney-Yin Deficiency
Blurred vision + photophobia	Liver-Blood Deficiency or Liver-Yang Rising
Dry eyes	Liver and/or Kidney-Yin Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Every eye complaint circles back to Liver (and its deep partner, Kidney-Yin) — exactly consistent with the Wind Wheel/Liver-eye relationship from Observation.

Feeling of Cold, Heat & Fever

寒熱

Aversion to cold is objective — the patient feels cold even in a warm room, possibly with shivering. From invasion of Wind obstructing the Cou Li, where Wei Qi normally warms the muscles.

Fever doesn't necessarily mean a raised temperature — it means the body feels hot on palpation. Intensity reflects the struggle between Zheng Qi and the pathogenic factor, not which pathogen it is.

Simultaneous aversion to cold + fever = the classic sign of exterior invasion (Taiyang stage / Wei level). **Alternating** cold and heat = Shaoyang stage (Gallbladder/San Jiao), Four-Level equivalent: Qi-level Gallbladder Heat.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Simultaneous = the pathogen is still fighting at the surface (exterior). Alternating = it's gotten in far enough to argue with the body's own Qi back and forth (Shaoyang, the half-in-half-out stage).

Emotional Symptoms — Anxiety

焦慮

Pattern	Indication
Insomnia, palpitations	Heart-Blood Deficiency
Worse in evening, night sweating	Heart-Yin Deficiency
Depression, blurred vision	Liver-Blood Deficiency
Insomnia, timidity, palpitations	Heart and Gall Bladder Qi Deficiency
Irritability, hypochondrial distention	Liver-Qi Stagnation (Full)
Outbursts of anger, red face/eyes, thirst	Liver-Fire (Full)
Severe, mouth/tongue ulcers	Heart-Fire (Full)
Stabbing chest pain radiating to shoulder	Heart Blood Stasis (Full)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Empty-condition anxiety feels like not-enough (deficiency, worse when tired). Full-condition anxiety feels like too-much (fire, stagnation, something actively pushing back).

Emotional Symptoms — Worry, Grief & Irritability

憂 · 悲 · 怒

Worry/Overthinking: palpitations + loose stools = Heart & Spleen Qi Deficiency. Cough + weak voice = Lung-Qi Deficiency. Worsens after menses in women = Liver-Blood Deficiency.

Sadness/Grief: crying + breathlessness + dislike of speaking = Lung & Heart Qi Deficiency. Crying + confusion, blurred vision = Liver-Blood Deficiency.

Irritability/Anger can stem from: Qi Stagnation, Blood Stasis, Liver-Yang Rising, Blood Deficiency, or Yin Deficiency (with or without Empty-Heat) — five very different roots for the same surface emotion.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Anger isn't one pattern, it's a surface symptom with at least five possible engines underneath it — the accompanying signs (not the anger itself) tell you which one.

Sleep & Insomnia

睡眠 · 失眠

Sleep depends on the state of Blood and Yin, especially Heart and Liver. The Shen and Ethereal Soul (Hun) must be anchored by sufficient Heart and Liver Blood for good sleep.

Finding	Indication
Difficulty falling asleep, dizziness, blurred vision	Liver-Blood Deficiency
Insomnia + anxiety, dream-disturbed	Heart and Spleen Blood Deficiency
Waking many times at night	Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat
Waking early, can't fall back asleep	Gall Bladder Deficiency
Dream-disturbed sleep	Liver-Fire or Heart-Fire
Restless sleep, excessive dreams	Retention of food

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sleep needs both fuel (Blood) and containment (Yin) — not enough of either and the Shen has nowhere stable to settle for the night.

Dreams — Bonus, Not Tested

夢

Schrier's own slide title: "Bonus Material on Sleep — Will Not Be Tested On." Genuinely interesting, not exam material.

Ling Shu 43: excess pathogenic Qi settling in different body locations produces specific dream imagery (e.g., settling in the nape produces dreams of decapitation; in the legs, dreams of being stuck). Su Wen 17/80: organ-Qi abundance or depletion also shapes dream content (Liver Qi abundant = dreams of anger; Kidney Qi depleted = dreams of boats and drowning).

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Once Zhuangzi dreamed he was a butterfly, and on waking couldn't say for certain whether he was a man who'd dreamed of being a butterfly, or a butterfly now dreaming he was a man. Read for the philosophy here, not the quiz.

Sexual Symptoms — Men

男性

Finding	Indication
Impotence + cold, backache, clear urine	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Impotence + dizziness, palpitations	Heart-Blood Deficiency
Impotence + insomnia, dream-disturbed, rapid pulse	Heart-Fire
Scrotal heaviness, sticky yellow discharge	Damp-Heat in Liver channel
Premature ejaculation, tiredness after	Kidney Deficiency
Lack of libido	Kidney, Spleen, Heart, or Lung Deficiency (context-dependent)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same organ-deficiency logic as everywhere else, applied to a topic patients rarely bring up unprompted — worth asking about directly, gently.

Sexual Symptoms — Women

女性

Finding	Indication
Lack of libido / can't reach orgasm	Kidney or Heart Deficiency, esp. "Kidney-Yang
Excessive sexual desire	Liver or Heart-Fire, or Empty-Heat from Kidney-Yin "Deficiency
Inability to reach orgasm specifically	Heart Deficiency
Headache after orgasm	Rebellious Qi of the Penetrating Vessel (Chong Mai), or "Heart-Fire

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

The Chong Mai (Penetrating Vessel) shows up here specifically — a reminder that women's health symptoms often route through the Extraordinary Vessels, not just the standard 12.

Menstruation

月經

Category	Finding	Indication
Cycle	Always early	Blood-Heat or Qi Deficiency
Cycle	Always late	Blood Deficiency or Stagnation of Blood/ Cold
Quality	Congeaed with clots	Blood Stasis or Cold
Quality	Watery	Blood or Yin Deficiency
Quality	Turbid	Blood-Heat or Cold Stagnation
Pain	Before period	Stagnation of Qi or Blood
Pain	During period	Blood-Heat or Cold Stagnation
Pain	After period	Blood Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Pain timing relative to the period itself is the fastest sort here: before=something's stuck (stagnation), during=active heat or cold, after=simply not enough Blood left to nourish.

Leukorrhea & Pregnancy

帶下 · 妊娠

Leukorrhea (vaginal discharge): color and texture follow the same Damp-Heat vs. Cold-Damp logic as elsewhere — watery/clear points Cold-Damp, thick/yellow points Damp-Heat.

Infertility: Blood or Kidney-Essence Deficiency, Damp-Phlegm in the Lower Burner, or Blood Stasis/Cold in the Uterus.

Vomiting during pregnancy: Stomach and Chong Vessel Deficiency — the Chong Mai again, tied to its role carrying Blood during pregnancy.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Infertility gets sorted the same four ways as almost everything else in this course: not enough material (Blood/Essence Deficiency), pooled fluid (Phlegm), or something physically blocked (Stasis/Cold).

Children's Symptoms

小兒

Same pattern-based framework, applied to pediatrics.

Finding	Indication
Abdominal pain	Cold in Stomach/Intestines, or Qi Stagnation
Vomiting milk (infants)	Retention of food
Cough, wheezing, earache	Wind invasion attacking the Lungs
Disturbed sleep + crying (infants)	Food retention or Stomach-Heat
Disturbed sleep (older children)	Liver-Fire or Stomach-Heat

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Children run hotter and more Yang by constitution (per the Observation material on kids as "little bundles of Yang energy") – worth keeping in mind before over-reading a heat sign as pathological in a pediatric patient.

Body — Whole-Body Pain, Back Pain & Numbness

全身痛 · 背痛 · 麻木

Finding	Indication
Sudden whole-body pain + aversion to cold/fever	Exterior Wind invasion
Ache all over + tiredness	Qi-Blood Deficiency
Back pain, dull, chronic	Kidney Deficiency
Back pain, recent, severe, stabbing, worse with damp weather	Invasion of " "exterior Cold and Damp
Numbness, both sides, arms/legs	Blood Deficiency
Numbness, one side, first three fingers	Internal Wind and Phlegm — "possible impending Wind-stroke

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

One-sided numbness in the first three fingers specifically is flagged as a genuine warning sign for impending Wind-stroke — worth remembering as a real clinical red flag, not just a quiz fact.

Face — Nose, Gums, Mouth & Cold Sores

鼻 · 齦 · 口瘡 · 唇疱

Finding	Indication
Acute runny nose, clear	Wind-Cold invasion
Acute runny nose, yellow/thick	Wind-Heat invasion
Chronic, clear, watery	Lung-Qi Deficiency with Cold
Bleeding gums + tiredness, loose stools	Deficient Spleen-Qi not holding Blood
Bleeding gums + heat, thirst	Stomach Full-Heat
Mouth ulcers, inside cheeks	Stomach-Heat
Mouth ulcers, tip of tongue	Heart-Fire or Heart Empty-Heat
Cold sores, sudden, burning	Stomach-Heat
Cold sores, recurring over years	Stomach Empty-Heat or Qi Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Acute-and-inflamed vs. chronic-and-recurring is the same Full-vs-Empty sort showing up again — sudden and angry points Full-Heat, recurring-for-years points Empty-Heat or plain Deficiency.

Limbs — Atrophy, Flaccidity & Tremor

肢體：痿·弛·顫

Finding	Indication
Atrophy/flaccidity, early stage	Stomach and Spleen–Qi Deficiency
Atrophy/flaccidity, later stage	Liver/Kidney–Yin Deficiency, or Spleen/"Kidney–Yang Deficiency
Tremor, hands	Liver–Wind
Tremor, elderly, all four limbs	Liver–Wind and Phlegm affecting channels
Fine tremor, women	Liver–Wind from Liver–Blood Deficiency
Cold hands + palpitations, dizziness	Heart–Blood Deficiency
Cold fingertips specifically	Liver–Qi Stagnation

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Atrophy tracks a timeline: starts as a Spleen/Stomach problem (not enough being made), and if it persists long enough, becomes a deeper Liver/Kidney–Yin or Yang problem (the reserves themselves running out).

PART SEVEN

Palpation

觸診 Chù Zhěn

Everything beyond the pulse: channels, skin, hands, abdomen, and the specialized points used for diagnosis. 15 entries.

Umbilical Pulse

臍脈 · Worsley

A Worsley-tradition technique, not standard TCM curriculum. Patient lies supine, breathes in and out; practitioner presses into the belly button on the exhale, feeling for a pulse directly at the center.

If the pulse is felt off-center, this can throw off the "grounding" of treatment. Correct by gently massaging the area back toward center before re-checking.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

An off-center umbilical pulse is treated as a genuine block to treatment in this system — worth checking and correcting before doing anything else, not just a curiosity.

Channel Palpation — Technique

循經觸診

Palpate along the course of each of the 12 primary channels, generally forearm (wrist–elbow) and lower leg (ankle–knee) — the classical focus, tied to the Five Transport (Wu Shu) points. Direction: palpate UP the limb (toward elbow/knee), following transport–point flow, not down.

Three passes, increasing pressure each time (light/medium/deep — the Heaven/Earth/ Human, Jing/Qi/Shen layering used throughout this course).

Finding	Indication
Tenderness/pain	Excess condition (accumulation of pathogenic Qi)
Weak/soft (with or without tenderness)	Qi Stagnation
Slippery and/or hard	Phlegm

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A nodule under the skin is a gummy bear left out of the package: fresh and squishy = still soft tissue reacting normally. Hard and stale = something's been sitting there a while.

Palpating the Skin — Temperature

膚溫

Finding	Indication
Cold feeling	Cold pattern
Four limbs cold	Spleen and Stomach Yang Deficiency
Loins/lower back/feet cold	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Skin hot	Heat or Damp-Heat
Hot on first touch, fades with sustained pressure	Exterior Wind-Heat, still "only at the Exterior
Hot on medium pressure, not heavy	Interior Heat in the Middle Burner
Hot on heavy pressure, nearly reaching bone	Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency " "(steaming bone pattern)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Where the heat lives under your hand tells you the depth of the problem: fades at the surface = still exterior. Only shows up pressing to the bone = the deepest Yin-Deficiency heat there is.

Palpating the Skin — Moisture & Texture

膚濕 · 膚質

Finding	Indication
Moist skin	Invasion of exterior Wind
Dry skin	Blood or Yin Deficiency
Rough skin	Bi Syndrome from Wind
Scaly and dry	Exhaustion of Body Fluids or severe Liver–Blood Deficiency
Swollen, pitting	Water Swelling — Spleen/Kidney–Yang Deficiency
Swollen, non-pitting	Qi Swelling — Dampness or Qi Stagnation

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Pitting edema (leaves a dent) is always Yang Deficiency — not enough warmth to move fluid. Non-pitting (springs back) is Qi Stagnation — the fluid's stuck, not just unmoved.

Palpating Hands & Feet

手足觸診

Finding	Indication
Cold hands and feet	Kidney–Yang Deficiency or Liver–Qi Stagnation
Cold hands only	Lung and/or Heart–Yang Deficiency
Cold feet only	Kidney–Yang Deficiency
Cold hands and feet, women	Blood Deficiency
Cold feet, women specifically	Liver–Blood Deficiency
Cold fingers and toes specifically	Liver–Qi Stagnation

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Liver–Qi Stagnation can leave someone with a warm chest/torso but cold hands and feet — the Liver holds the warmth in the center and doesn't let it reach the extremities.

Palpating the Palm

掌診

Compare dorsal (back of hand) vs. palm: hot dorsal surface = Full-Heat; hot palm = Empty-Heat (Ling Shu 74). The palm broadly reflects internal organ states, similar in principle to ear reflexology.

Sharp pain on pressing a palm zone = Full condition. Dull soreness = Empty condition.

ZONE MAPPING (MASTER TUNG TRADITION)

Index finger → Lung. Middle finger → Heart. Ring finger → Liver & Spleen. Pinky → Kidney. Note: Master Tung's system uses zones, not standard channel theory.

NOT TESTED

Schrier explicitly states Master Tung's full palm diagnosis system is not tested unless taught as its own separate unit.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Dorsal vs. palm is the same Full-vs-Empty logic as everywhere else in this book, just applied to two sides of the same hand instead of two different patients.

Palm Vessel Color

掌脈色

Color	Indication
Blue or black	Pain
Dark blue	Pain and Excess
Red or purple	Heat, inflammation
Yellow with atrophy	Deficiency
Blue, red, and black together	Mixed Heat and Cold
Very dark, gloomy	Pathogen has invaded to the Interior
Light color	Pathogen still at the Exterior

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Ling Shu 10's own example: greenish-blue vessels in the palm point to cold in the Stomach; red ones at the same location point to heat there instead — same location, opposite reading, color is everything.

Apical Beat (Xu Li)

虛里

The pulse of the heart/left ventricle, felt in the fifth intercostal space. Reflects the state of Zong Qi (Gathering Qi).

Finding	Indication
Clearly felt, not hard, relatively slow	Normal
Feeble, without strength	Deficiency of Zong Qi
Strong and hard	Excess condition
Large but empty	Heart-Qi Deficiency
Stopping and starting	Severe shock or alcoholism
Discrepancy between apical beat and radial pulse	Poor prognosis

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

This one is genuinely on the national boards, not just this course — the fifth intercostal space location and the basic normal/deficient/excess read are worth knowing cold.

Below the Xiphoid Process

劍突下

Reflects the state of Upper Burner Qi (Lung and Heart) and Zong Qi. Should feel relatively soft compared to the rest of the abdomen.

Finding	Indication
Hard	Full condition, stagnation of Lung/Heart Qi
Too soft, giving	Heart Qi Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A little give is normal — like a well-maintained stair step. No give at all (hard) means something's jammed; too much give (mushy) means there's not enough structure holding it up.

Palpating the Chest & Breast

胸診・乳診

Finding	Indication
Tender, light palpation, CV17	Heart Blood Stasis
Tender around center	Lung Excess
Tenderness relieved by palpation	Heart or Lung Deficiency
Relieved by light palpation but worse with deep	Mixed Deficiency and Excess

BREAST LUMPS

Never a replacement for a Western medical workup. Relatively hard = Blood Stasis or Cold. Distinct edges = Phlegm. Indistinct edges = Toxic Heat. Mobile on palpation = Phlegm/Dampness. Immobile = Blood Stasis or Toxic Heat.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same soft/hard, mobile/fixed logic that sorts every lump and mass in this course — the body only really has a few ways of making a lump, and each has its own texture signature.

Abdominal Diagnosis — The Five-Phase Map

腹診：五行圖

Nan Jing 16/56. Below the sternum (Ren 12–15) = Heart/Fire. Around the umbilicus (Ren 7–Ren 12) = Spleen/Earth. Below the umbilicus (Ren 7 to pubis) = Kidney/Water. Right side below the ribcage = Lung/Metal. Left side below the ribcage = Liver/Wood.

Japanese abdominal diagnosis (Hara) developed this further — Waichi Sugiyama (credited with inventing guide tubes) and later Todo Yoshimasu tied specific abdominal findings directly to herbal formula indications.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same face-map, same five-phase logic, just moved down to the belly — sternum-to-pubis instead of forehead-to-chin.

The Normal Abdomen & Abdominal Masses

正常腹 · 腹塊

Normal: solid but not hard, resilient but not tight, elastic but not soft.

Finding	Indication
Hard and/or pain aggravated by palpation	Full condition
Too soft and/or ache relieved by palpation	Empty condition
Lower abdomen soft, flabby	Deficiency of Original Qi (Yuan Qi)
Masses that come and go, move on palpation	Qi Stagnation
Fixed masses	Blood Stasis

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A mass that moves when you press it is Qi (invisible, mobile by nature). A mass that stays put no matter what is Blood (physical, stuck).

Front Mu, Back Shu & Ah Shi Points

募穴 · 俞穴 · 阿是穴

Front Mu (Alarm) Points: where Qi of the organs collects/accumulates, on the front surface, providing access to the Yin aspect of organ function. More geared toward treating Excess.

Back Shu (Transport) Points: on the back, strong reserve of Qi, provide strong tonification or sedation for the corresponding organ. Better for Deficiency, though also used to clear Excess. Position tracks vertically with organ height — BL13 (Lung, high) sits above BL23 (Kidney, low).

Ah Shi Points: literally "oh yes, that's it" points — tender spots with no fixed location, found by palpation alone.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Front Mu points collect Qi like a drain catches water — useful for reading and releasing Excess. Back Shu points are more like a battery terminal — useful for adding charge back in (tonifying Deficiency).

Aggressive Energy (Worsley)

積氣 · Worsley

A Five-Element Worsley concept: "toxic" Qi circulating along the Ke (Control) Cycle between the Yin organs. Often internally caused (family/relationship stress, financial worry, work issues); can also come from external causes (shock).

Feels under the fingertip like an electric razor's buzz. Treated with BL13, 14, 15, 18, 20, 23 — needled with a test needle placed off to the side, watching for erythema (redness) around the needle as a marker of toxic Heat draining out.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

There's no reliable way to diagnose Aggressive Energy except by doing the treatment itself and watching what happens — genuinely one of the few TCM concepts that's diagnosed retroactively, through the treatment's own response.

Palpating the Three Jiao

三焦觸診

Upper Jiao (chest, above diaphragm): Heart, Pericardium, Lung. Middle Jiao (diaphragm to navel): Stomach, Spleen, Liver, Gallbladder. Lower Jiao (below navel): Small Intestine, Large Intestine, Bladder, Kidney.

Assess visually and by touch for warmth and Qi strength in each burner. The goal isn't necessarily all three burners being warm — it's whether they're relatively *even* with each other. A large discrepancy (e.g. very cold lower burner, very hot upper/middle) points to a specific regional excess or deficiency more than uniform temperature does.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Three thermostats set to the same temperature (even if that temperature is a little cold) is a more stable, addressable situation than three thermostats fighting each other at wildly different settings.

PART EIGHT

Hearing & Smelling

聞診 Wén Zhěnn

The last of the Four Pillars. Voice, breath, cough, and the full range of body and secretion odors. 17 entries.

Voice & the Zang-Fu

聲音與臟腑

Lung: the gateway to the voice and movement of Qi; helps create sound. Production of sound is directly tied to this organ.

Kidney: the root of the voice. Root of Yuan Qi (Source Qi); controls the reception of Qi. The *volume* of the voice is directly related to Kidney.

Spleen & Stomach: the acquired root of Qi. Influences vocalization and vocal strength.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Lung makes the sound happen at all. Kidney gives it volume/depth. Spleen/Stomach fuels the whole operation day to day — three organs, three different jobs, one voice.

The Five Element Sounds

五音

Element	Sound	Quality
Wood	Shouting	Forceful, assertive; wants to be heard or is demanding "change"
Fire	Laughing	Expresses joy; can be a giggle without an actual laugh "emerging"
Earth	Singing	Occurs naturally soothing a child or distressed animal; "pitch rises and falls"
Metal	Weeping	Consumes/dissolves Qi; non-verbal, faltering words, "choked-back quality"
Water	Groaning	Little modulation; flat, as if the voice's normal ups and downs have been squeezed out

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same Five Element logic as everywhere else in this course, just listened to instead of looked at — Wood pushes outward (shout), Water flattens out (groan).

Voice — Abnormal Vocalizations

聲音異常

Finding	Indication
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Weak and vague	Exterior Wind-Cold, or Dampness
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi Deficiency
Excessive talking	Heat pattern

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Kids are described in lecture as "little hot buckets" — constant talking, constant questions — which tracks: excessive talking reads Heat, and children run hot and Yang by constitution.

Voice — Loss & Hoarseness

失聲 · 聲嘶

Finding	Indication
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin Deficiency
Sudden onset, low-pitched, raspy	Exterior pattern
Chronic, gradual intensity	Blood Stagnation
Hoarseness with plum-pit sensation and cough	Phlegm-Heat
Chronic, gradually worse in the evening	Lung and Kidney Yin Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sudden and raspy = something just invaded (Exterior/Wind-Heat). Slow-building over time, worse at night = the deep Yin reserves running low — same day/night, sudden/gradual logic that runs through this whole course.

Breathing & Respiration

呼吸

Finding	Indication
Coarse, loud breathing	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess Qi in Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of Qi in Liver and Kidneys
Rapid inhalation, rough respiration	Heat Excess
Faint respiration, slow inhale/exhale	Deficiency or chronic internal condition

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Loud and rough = there's too much pushing through (Excess).
Faint and slow = not enough force behind it at all (Deficiency) — the same volume-tells-you-the-story principle as voice.

Panting & Abnormal Respiration

喘 · 呼吸異常

Panting: intense, rapid, uneven breath with nostrils moving, mouth open, shoulders rising. Can indicate Excess (surplus of external contraction or Phlegm-Heat, loud/rough) or Deficiency (irregular, faint, low, related to Kidney's inability to grasp Qi).

Type	Mechanism
Wheezing	Lung Qi fails to descend, with Phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung Qi rises to the throat, obstructing the air tract
Shortness of Breath	Lung-Qi Deficiency or Water Retention in the chest
Shortage of Qi	Lung-Qi obstruction/Deficiency, or Zong Qi insufficient

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A panting dog on a hot day (loud, fast, open-mouthed) is the Excess picture. A tired or unwell dog's soft, shallow breathing is the Deficiency picture — same breath, opposite story.

Cough & Sneezing

咳 · 嚏

Cough: due to Lung Qi not diffusing/descending, rising in counterflow, or Phlegm/ Qi flooding the airways. Loud = Full/Heat. Dry = Lung-Yin Deficiency. Weak = Empty. Productive (with phlegm, sound) vs. Unproductive (sound, no phlegm).

Sneezing: acute, loud = Heat/Excess. Chronic, soft = Lung-Qi Deficiency. Sudden, in a critical stage of chronic illness = Yang collapse. Due to external stimulation (pepper, sunlight, perfume) = normal, not pathological.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A wet, productive cough clears something out (phlegm actually moving). A dry, unproductive cough is just irritation with nothing to show for it — usually a Yin-Deficiency picture, not enough fluid to lubricate.

Vomiting, Belching & Hiccup

嘔 · 噯氣 · 呃逆

Symptom	Mechanism	Full/Loud	Empty/Quiet
Vomiting	Stomach Qi rebels upward, forcing food/fluid out with sound	Sudden, forceful, loud (Stomach-Heat)	Slow, weak, without force (Stomach Deficiency/"Cold")
Belching	Stomach Qi rebellion, sound from the throat	Loud, long (food retention, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach)	Short, low (Stomach-Qi Deficiency, possibly with Cold)
Hiccup	Qi rebellion causes involuntary diaphragm spasm, short sound	Loud (often Liver-Qi invading Stomach)	Quiet, low (Stomach-Qi or Stomach-Yin Deficiency)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

All three are the Stomach's Qi trying to go the wrong direction (up instead of down) – the only real question is how loud the argument is, and loud always means more force behind the rebellion (Full), quiet means less (Empty).

Borborygmi, Sighing & Yawning

腸鳴 · 嘆息 · 呵欠

Borborygmi (intestinal gurgling): loud = Full pattern, often with diarrhea/ dysentery, Damp-Heat in Spleen/Intestines. Low sound = Empty pattern, Spleen/Kidney-Yang Deficiency.

Sighing: generally Liver or Lung Qi Stagnation. Often from repressed anger/emotional constraint (Liver) or worry/sadness (Lung). A weak sighing sound can be Spleen/Heart Deficiency from sadness, grief, or pensiveness.

Yawning: frequent, loud, relieved by yawning, triggered by emotion = Liver-Qi Stagnation. With chest pain after injury/ chronic illness = Blood and Qi Stagnation. Infrequent, weak = Spleen/Kidney-Yang Deficiency.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A sigh is the body's own release valve for stuck Liver or Lung Qi — which is exactly why it feels better afterward. The body's doing on purpose what acupuncture tries to do on purpose too.

The Six Healing Sounds

六字訣

A qigong practice pairing specific exhaled sounds with organs, used therapeutically rather than diagnostically.

Sound	Organ	Effect
He	Heart	Expels heat, calms the heart
Hu	Spleen	Clears heat, strengthens Spleen
Si	Lung	Descends Qi, clears heat/phlegm
Chui	Kidney	Removes Wind/Cold, calms Kidney
Xu	Liver	Clears heat, relieves stagnation
Xi	Triple Burner	Clears heat and restlessness

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Not something you diagnose from — something you'd actually teach a patient to do at home, a rare moment in this course where the diagnostic tool doubles as the treatment.

Diagnosis by Smelling — The Basic Split

嗅診：基本原則

Two aspects: (1) the patient's own body odor, which can point toward both pattern and constitutional type; (2) the odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine, stool, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas).

Quality	Indication
Foul, rotten, fetid, stinking	Heat or Excess
Fishy or odorless	Cold or Deficient

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Same cold-doesn't-smell, heat-cooks-and-stinks principle that's run through this entire course — now applied as the master key to every smell-based finding that follows.

Body Odor

體味

Odor	Indication
Goatish	Wind, Damp, Heat accumulation
Foul, fox-like	Epidemic infectious disease or Summer-Heat toxin
Foul, specifically in the armpit	Damp-Heat accumulation

Body odors are usually detected best on the back, and reflect the pattern currently present — not necessarily the patient's constitutional Element type.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Ask before you smell — tell the patient what you're doing and why before leaning in to check the back of the neck or lower back. This is a real, stated clinical courtesy, not just etiquette.

The Five Element Odors

五臭

Element	Odor	Character
Wood	Rancid	Fat no longer fresh, or newly-mown grass; sharp, "prickling"
Fire	Scorched	Burnt toast, scorched fabric
Earth	Fragrant	Not pleasant-fragrant — heavy, cloying, sickly—"sweet, lingers (mulch is the classic example)"
Metal	Rotten	Fills the nose with tiny prickles, makes you clench "your nose (garbage, decomposition)"
Water	Putrid	Rotting meat, stagnant pond, stale urine

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

"Fragrant" is the trap in this list — it doesn't mean pleasant. It means the specific heavy, cloying, sticks-to-your-nose quality of something like mulch, not a nice perfume.

Breath & Sweat Odor

口氣 · 汗味

Finding	Indication
Breath, strong/foul	Stomach-Heat or food retention
Breath, sour	Food retention/Accumulation Disorder
Breath, foul/pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach
Breath, rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Sweat, strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sweat, putrid-smelling	Disease of Lung, Liver, or Kidney

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Sweat forms in the space between skin and muscle where Dampness naturally accumulates — which is exactly why a strong sweat odor points toward Damp-Heat almost by default.

Sputum, Stool & Flatulence Odor

痰味 · 便味 · 屁味

Finding	Indication
Sputum, strong/rotten-smelling	Heat in the Lungs, usually Phlegm-Heat or "Toxic Heat
Sputum, fishy-smelling	Lung-Cold
Flatulence, extremely stinky	Food stagnation
Flatulence, sour/rotten (rotten eggs)	Toxic Heat
Flatulence, slight/odorless, worse with emotional stress	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Stool odor abnormal but faint, or frequent odorless flatulence	Spleen/Large "Intestine Deficiency

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Flatulence that gets worse specifically with stress, and doesn't smell that strong, is a genuine diagnostic tell for Liver-Qi Stagnation — not just an offhand joke.

Urine & Vaginal Discharge Odor

尿味 · 帶下味

Finding	Indication
Urine, frequent/urgent/ burning, turbid yellow, foul	Damp-Heat in the Bladder
Urine, heavy smell, scanty yellow	Heart-Fire pouring into the Bladder
Urine, clear, frequent, odorless (or slightly fishy)	Kidney Deficiency
Urine, odorless incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney Fire (Ming Men failing to "control the lower orifices")
Vaginal discharge, strong- smelling	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge, fishy	Damp-Cold
Lochia (postpartum), strong- smelling	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Odorless incontinence specifically points to Ming Men exhaustion — the body has lost the Fire needed to hold and control the lower orifices, not just a plumbing problem.

Odors of Nose, Ears & Eyes

鼻 · 耳 · 目之味

Location	Finding	Indication
Nose	Yellow, sticky discharge with odor	Heat in the Lung, or "Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach
Ears	Foul, fishy odor, turbid pus/discharge	Damp-Heat in the ear "(often Gallbladder channel)
Eyes	Red, swollen, turbid tears, foul/fishy odor	Heat/Damp-Heat in "the Liver channel

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

The nasal discharge's stomach connection makes sense once you trace it: Stomach's channel actually begins right at the nose, even though the Spleen is doing most of the actual dampness-generating work behind the scenes.

VOLUME 2

The Four Pillars, Complete

Observation, Inquiry, Palpation, Hearing & Smelling.
Everything Schrier taught for diagnosis in this course, in one book, sourced from the actual lectures rather than reconstructed from memory.

None of this replaces the other three legs of the stool. A single finding almost never stands alone — it's the whole picture, held together, that gets you to a pattern.

Go treat someone well.

Primary: Prof. Daniel Schrier, EAM310 Weeks 6–9. Supporting: Maciocia, Foundations of Chinese Medicine 3rd ed.; Unschuld, Huang Di Nei Jing (Su Wen & Ling Shu). All outside material paraphrased.